



WWE 2K22

THE REMATCH CLAUSE

By Shrey "TwinkleFairy" Pacheco | feedback@skoar.in

After a brief hiatus, 2K and Visual Concepts are back with WWE 2K22. With a tag-line like 'It Hits Different', you know that they really want to make you forget the past few years. Do they succeed? Let's find out.

Graphics and animation

With WWE 2K22, Visual Concepts seem to have outdone themselves. The Superstars look more realistic than ever. The team has done a commendable job of making them look more real. Even facial expressions look pretty good, although it's nowhere close to the level of most other AAA titles. Another area that definitely needed an overhaul was the animation. Thankfully, Visual Concepts have reworked the game engine from the ground up. The results are quite evident with 'meaty' hits and falls. The reversal animations are also well done

and many of them seamlessly blend in with the action.

While most issues have been squashed, there are some that rear their head once in a while. There have been times when a move fails to connect, which given the nature of the gameplay, can be a costly miss. Then there is the camera, which works fine most of the time, but tends to get caught behind foreground objects. This combined with the fact that objects in the foreground do not become transparent when the wrestlers are behind them means that the action can be hidden.

Controls and gameplay

WWE games have to straddle the line between arcade and simulation-style gameplay. WWE 2K22 leans more towards the arcade-style. The basic controls are quite simple with one button each for light strikes,

heavy strikes and grapples. You then combine these in different ways to pull off moves, similar to a combo from a fighting game. There is also a separate button from blocking and reversals. Holding it down blocks an attack while tapping it at the right moment can cause a reversal. But if you miss a reversal, then you'll have to endure the complete combo before you can reverse again. Unless you can guess your opponent's next button press, which can cause a reversal. But in this case, you won't be getting any prompts. This simple setup means that anyone can pick up and play a match.

The gameplay in WWE games is quite varied. WWE 2K22 offers plenty of match type options ranging from Backstage Brawls to Hell in a Cell to Elimination Chamber. However, it's still missing some classic, albeit niche, match types such as Buried Alive,